



HIGHER
SCHOOL
CERTIFICATE
TRIAL EXAMINATION

2020

BAULKHAM HILLS HIGH SCHOOL

English Extension 1

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write using black pen

**Total marks:
50****Section I – 25 marks** (pages 2–3)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section II – 25 marks (pages 4–8)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 2–6
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section I – Common Module: Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer the question in the writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
- craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language

Use Text 1 and Text 2 to answer Question 1.

Text 1 – Nonfiction Extract

“But back to our City of Invention. Let me put it like this - writers create Houses of the Imagination and Speculation, from whose doors the generations greet each other...in and out of the centuries.

And thus, by such discussion and such shared experience, do we understand ourselves and one another, and our pasts and our futures. It is in the literature, the novels, the fantasy, the fiction of the past, that you find *real* history, and not in text books. Thomas More's Utopia tells us as much about his own century, his own world, as the one he invented for the delectation of his peers.

Writers are privileged visitors here. They have a house or two of their own in the City, after all. Perhaps even well-thought of, and nicely maintained: or perhaps never much reckoned and falling into disrepair. But to have a house of any kind, even to have brought it only to planning stage, and have given up in despair, is to realise more fully the wonder of the City, and to know how its houses are built: to know also that though one brick may look much like another, and all builders go about their work in much the same way, some buildings will be good, some bad. And a very few, sometimes the least suspected, will last, and not crumble with the decades.

Builders vary in intellect, aspiration, talent and efficiency; they build well or badly in different suburbs of the City. Some build because they need to, have to, live to, or believe they are appointed to, others to prove a point or to change the world. But to build at all requires courage, persistence, faith and a surplus of animation. A writer's all is not taken up by the real world. There is something left over: enough for them to build these alternative, finite realities...

The good builders, the really good builders, carry a vision out of the real world and transpose it into the City of Invention, and refresh and enlighten the reader, so that on his, or her, return to reality, that reality itself is changed, however minutely. A book that has no base in an initial reality, written out of reason and not conviction, is a house built of - what shall we say? - bricks and no mortar? Walk into it, brush against a door frame, and the whole edifice falls down about your ears. Like the first little pig's house of straw, when the big bad wolf huffed and puffed.”

Extract from *Letters to Alice* by Fay Weldon

Text 2 – Prose fiction extract

A wind sprang high in the west, like a wave of unreasonable happiness, and tore eastward across England, trailing with it the frosty scent of forests and the cold intoxication of the sea. In a million holes and corners it refreshed a man like a flagon, and astonished him like a blow. In the inmost chambers of intricate and embowered houses it woke like a domestic explosion, littering the floor with some professor's papers till they seemed as precious as fugitive, or blowing out the candle by which a boy read *Treasure Island* and wrapping him in roaring dark. But everywhere it bore drama into undramatic lives, and carried the trump of crisis across the world. Many a harassed mother in a mean backyard had looked at five dwarfish shirts on the clothes-line as at some small, sick tragedy; it was as if she had hanged her five children. The wind came, and they were full and kicking as if five fat imps* had sprung into them; and far down in her oppressed subconscious she half-remembered those coarse comedies of her father's when the elves still dwelt in the homes of men. Many an unnoticed girl in a dank walled garden had tossed herself into the hammock with the same intolerant gesture with which she might have tossed herself into the Thames*; and that wind rent the waving wall of woods and lifted the hammock like a balloon, and showed her shapes of quaint clouds far beyond, and pictures of bright villages far below, as if she rode heaven in a fairy boat. Many a dusty clerk or cleric, plodding a telescopic road of poplars*, thought for the hundredth time that they were like the plumes of a hearse; when this invisible energy caught and swung and clashed them round his head like a wreath or salutation of seraphic* wings. There was in it something more inspired and authoritative even than the old wind of the proverb; for this was the good wind that blows nobody harm.

Opening of G.K Chesterton's *Manalive*

*imps – a small, mischievous sprite or devil

*the Thames – the river running through London

*poplars – tall, thin trees that are often line roads or fields as wind breaks

*seraphic – from seraph – a celestial being like an angel

Question 1 (25 marks)

- (a) Use **Text 1** and **Text 2** to answer this question:

Analyse to what extent both texts explore the value of building literary worlds.

Draw on your understanding of the module Literary Worlds in your response.

(10 marks)

- (b) Use **Text 2** to answer this question:

In a sustained piece of imaginative writing, build further on **one** of the scenarios in the extract; the refreshed man, the professor, the boy reading, the harassed mother, the unnoticed girl, or the dusty clerk to “carry a vision out of the real world and transpose it” into a world of your own creation.

Your response should draw on your knowledge and understanding of the module Literary Worlds and the extracts provided.

(15 marks)

Section II – Electives

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 2–6

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer the question in the writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
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Question 2 – Elective 1: Literary Homelands (25 marks)

Analyse how your study of the ideas and values in Literary Homelands has deepened your perception of the interplay between diversity and social status.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Aravind Adiga, *The White Tiger*
 - E M Forster, *A Passage to India*
 - Colm Tóibín, *Brooklyn*
- **Poetry**
 - Eileen Chong, *Burning Rice*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Burning Rice*
 - * *Mid-autumn Mooncakes*
 - * *My Hakka Grandmother*
 - * *Shophouse, Victoria Street*
 - * *Chinese Ginseng*
 - * *Winter Meeting*
 - * *Singapore*
- **Drama**
 - Andrew Bovell, *The Secret River* [by Kate Grenville – An adaptation for the stage by Andrew Bovell]
- **Film**
 - Sarah Gavron, *Brick Lane*

Question 3 – Elective 2: Worlds of Upheaval (25 marks)

Analyse how your study of the ideas and values in Worlds of Upheaval has deepened your perception of the interplay between desire and integrity.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction** – Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
 - Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
 - Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*
- **Poetry** – Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966–1996*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Digging*
 - * *The Strand at Lough Beg*
 - * *Casualty*
 - * *Funeral Rites*
 - * *Whatever You Say Say Nothing*
 - * *Triptych*
- **Drama** – Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*
- **Film** – Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

Question 4 – Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds (25 marks)

Analyse how your study of the ideas and values in Reimagined Worlds has deepened your perception of the interplay between knowledge and speculation.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Italo Calvino, *If on a Winter's Night a Traveller*
 - Ursula Le Guin, *The Left Hand of Darkness*
 - Jonathan Swift, *Gulliver's Travels*
- **Poetry**
 - Samuel Taylor Coleridge, *Samuel Taylor Coleridge: The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* (1834)
 - * *The Eolian Harp*
 - * *Kubla Khan*
 - * *Christabel*
 - Tracy K Smith, *Life on Mars*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Sci-Fi*
 - * *My God, It's Full of Stars*
 - * *Don't You Wonder, Sometimes?*
 - * *The Universe: Original Motion Picture Soundtrack*
 - * *The Universe as Primal Scream*
- **Film**
 - Guillermo Del Toro, *Pan's Labyrinth*

Question 5 – Elective 4: Literary Mindscapes (25 marks)

Analyse how your study of the ideas and values in Literary Mindscapes has deepened your perception of the interplay between desire and despair.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - William Faulkner, *As I Lay Dying*
 - Gail Jones, *Sixty Lights*
 - Katherine Mansfield, *The Collected Stories*
 - * *Prelude*
 - * *Je ne Parle pas Français*
 - * *Bliss*
 - * *Psychology*
 - * *The Daughters of the Late Colonel*
- **Poetry**
 - Emily Dickinson, *The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *I felt a Funeral, in my Brain*
 - * *This is my letter to the World*
 - * *I died for Beauty – but was scarce*
 - * *I had been hungry, all the Years*
 - * *Because I could not stop for Death*
 - * *My Life has stood – a Loaded Gun*
 - * *A word dropped careless on a Page*
- **Drama**
 - William Shakespeare, *Hamlet*
- **Film**
 - Sofia Coppola, *Lost in Translation*

Question 6 – Elective 5: Intersecting Worlds (25 marks)

Analyse how your study of the ideas and values in *Intersecting Worlds* has deepened your perception of the interplay between practicality and preservation.

In your response, refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction** – Melissa Harrison, *Clay*
 - Alex Miller, *Journey to the Stone Country*
 - Annie Proulx, *The Shipping News*
- **Nonfiction** – Tim Winton, *Island Home*
- **Poetry** – William Wordsworth, *William Wordsworth: The Major Works*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Lines written a few miles above Tintern Abbey*
 - * *Three years she grew in sun and shower*
 - * *My heart leaps up when I behold*
 - * *Resolution and Independence*
 - * *The world is too much with us*
 - * *Ode ('There was a time')*
 - * *The Solitary Reaper*
 - * *The Prelude* (1805) – Book One, lines 1–67, 271– 441
- **Film** – Daniel Nettheim, *The Hunter*

End of paper